CONSTRUCTION CLIENT ENGAGEMENT

CanConstructNZ

Construction Client Engagement and Industry Insights

Construction Clients Group | July 2026

ENGAGEMENT PURPOSE

To test the relevance and potential industry value of the CanConstructNZ Smart System with major New Zealand construction clients and advisers, and to identify priorities for future development and industry collaboration.

More than 40 participants

Major public and private construction clients, Crown entities, developers and professional advisers.

A strong client-side signal for demand-and-capacity intelligence

CanConstructNZ engaged with more than 40 participants from major New Zealand construction client organisations and their advisers. The session introduced the emerging Smart System and explored whether its central proposition - connecting future construction demand with the sector capacity and capability available to deliver it - responds to practical client-side planning needs.

100%	80%	60%	80%
rated demand-versus-capacity intelligence extremely valuable	found future capacity somewhat difficult to understand	identified workload uncertainty and market volatility	were very willing to share anonymised pipeline data

What the engagement indicates

- Major clients recognise a visibility gap between planned project demand and the sector resources likely to be available when projects reach the market.
- Respondents see clear value in a tool that brings pipeline demand and sector capacity/capability into a single decision-support environment.
- The potential value extends beyond forecasting to scenario testing, portfolio sequencing, procurement planning and broader sector coordination.
- Data collaboration appears feasible, but adoption will depend on confidentiality, governance, data quality, transparent assumptions and trust in forecasts.

OVERALL ENGAGEMENT OUTCOME

The engagement provides positive user-needs and stakeholder-relevance evidence for the direction of CanConstructNZ. It also identifies a clear pathway from research prototype to trusted client-oriented decision support.

Note: Percentages refer to valid respondents to the voluntary post-engagement survey and are indicative rather than statistically representative of all attendees.

Engaging organisations that shape New Zealand's construction pipeline

Major construction clients influence not only individual projects but the wider market. Decisions about funding, timing, sequencing, packaging and procurement collectively determine when demand reaches contractors, consultants and supply chains. Yet these decisions are often made with incomplete visibility of the sector's future ability to respond.

The Construction Clients Group engagement brought the CanConstructNZ research directly to more than 40 participants from major public and private client organisations and professional advisers. The engagement was designed to test three questions:

1. **Is the problem relevant?**
   Do clients experience difficulty understanding future sector capacity and aligning project timing with market conditions?
2. **Is the Smart System proposition useful?**
   Would connecting project-pipeline demand with sector capacity and capability support better planning and decision-making?
3. **What would make it usable in practice?**
   Which functions, data arrangements and trust conditions are required for industry adoption?

WHY CLIENT PERSPECTIVES MATTER

CanConstructNZ is intended to support decisions at the boundary between project pipelines and sector delivery. Client organisations therefore provide a critical test of whether the research addresses the decisions that generate and sequence construction demand.

Respondent perspectives

The small post-engagement survey included responses from private infrastructure construction, local government and consultancy perspectives, with roles spanning procurement/delivery, portfolio planning and project delivery. The wider engagement audience was substantially larger and more diverse than the survey sample.

From pipeline forecasting to portfolio intelligence

The presentation positioned CanConstructNZ as an integrated forecasting, simulation and decision-support system. Its distinctive proposition is to connect future demand with the sector resources available to deliver that demand, rather than treating pipeline information and market capacity as separate datasets.

FUTURE SCENARIOS	PIPELINE FORECAST	MARKET REPLICA	SIMULATE & MATCH	DECISION OUTPUTS
Population and economic assumptions	Expected construction demand	Reconstructed sector and firm characteristics	Project allocation and capacity interactions	Capacity pressure, scenarios and portfolio insight

Potential applications discussed

Project and portfolio planning
Compare planned programmes with expected market workload.

Scenario and disruption analysis
Test delayed projects, shocks and alternative timing assumptions.

Programme visibility
Understand cumulative project demand rather than individual pipelines in isolation.

Sector capacity and capability
Identify potential pressure, surplus or deficit in delivery resources.

Economic modelling and analysis
Explore how macroeconomic and population scenarios may translate into construction demand.

Disaster recovery planning
Examine recovery demand against constrained sector resources.

THE CORE PROPOSITION

CanConstructNZ is not intended to be another static project list. Its potential value lies in interpreting what the future pipeline means for the market in which projects must actually be delivered.

Clients see a persistent visibility problem

Survey responses indicate that understanding future construction capacity remains difficult and that this uncertainty influences project decisions.

Understanding future construction capacity is somewhat difficult 80%

The remaining 20% selected neither easy nor difficult; no valid respondent described the task as easy.

Most frequently identified challenges

Uncertainty about sector workload 60%

Market volatility (booms and downturns) 60%

Funding / approval timing mismatches 40%

Poor data on regional capacity 20%

One respondent selected an “all of the above” option through the open-text field, reinforcing that the challenges are experienced as interconnected rather than isolated.

How these challenges affect decisions

Delayed projects 60%

Increased costs 60%

Conservative planning / project deferral 40%

Risk of project failure 20%

CLIENT SIGNAL

Limited sector visibility is not simply an information issue. Respondents linked it directly to timing, cost, deferral and delivery risk - the kinds of consequences portfolio intelligence should help clients anticipate earlier.

Strong support for the central value proposition

100%	80%
rated the demand-versus-capacity comparison extremely valuable	were very willing to contribute anonymised pipeline data

Every valid respondent rated a tool comparing project-pipeline demand with sector capacity and capability as “extremely valuable”. Preferred functionality included scenario testing, a forward view of sector workload and decision support for prioritisation. The pattern favours an integrated platform rather than a single-purpose forecasting output.

A viable path to industry data collaboration

Four of the five valid respondents were “very willing” to contribute anonymised, non-commercial project pipeline data; the remaining respondent did not answer the question. This is encouraging, but the accompanying concerns show that participation is conditional on a trusted data model.

Confidentiality
Commercial sensitivity was the most consistent concern.

Governance
Users need clarity on access, ownership and permitted use.

Data quality
Accuracy and reliability affect confidence in outputs.

Security
Privacy and security remain important participation conditions.

Effort
Contribution should minimise reporting and maintenance burden.

Value exchange
Organisations need to see how contribution improves decisions.

Trust will determine adoption

The most recurrent potential barrier was lack of trust in forecasts or predictions. Respondents also raised data quality, fit with existing planning processes, ease of interpretation, relevance to decisions, confidentiality and uncertainty about benefits. Future development therefore needs to combine model performance with transparent assumptions, clear uncertainty communication and usable decision narratives.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

The strongest product will not simply generate more sophisticated forecasts. It will make credible forecasts understandable, interrogable and relevant to specific portfolio and procurement decisions.

What the engagement means for CanConstructNZ

Client signal	Engagement evidence	Development implication
Future capacity is difficult to see	80% somewhat difficult	Keep forward sector capacity at the centre of the system.
Uncertainty affects project outcomes	Delays and costs most frequently selected	Link sector forecasts explicitly to portfolio decisions.
Demand-versus-capacity intelligence is valued	100% extremely valuable	Strong user-needs signal for the core Smart System concept.
Clients may contribute data	80% very willing	Develop a structured data-collaboration proposition.
Trust and confidentiality matter	Recurring adoption and contribution concerns	Prioritise governance, validation and transparent uncertainty.

Five priorities for the next phase

1. **Build a client-facing portfolio view**
   Translate sector forecasts into information directly relevant to project sequencing, market timing and procurement planning.
2. **Strengthen scenario functionality**
   Allow users to test project delays, changing timing, market shocks and alternative pipeline assumptions.
3. **Demonstrate forecast credibility**
   Continue technical validation while clearly communicating assumptions, confidence and limitations.
4. **Establish a trusted data-governance proposition**
   Define minimum data requirements, anonymisation, aggregation, access, ownership and value exchange.
5. **Move into structured co-development**
   Use pilot testing with major clients to determine which outputs create sufficient decision value to become embedded in practice.

From engagement to co-development

The Construction Clients Group engagement represents an important step in translating CanConstructNZ from research into industry-facing decision support. The presentation demonstrated how pipeline forecasts, sector modelling and agent-based simulation can be combined to explore the balance between future demand and delivery capacity.

The post-engagement feedback strongly supports the relevance of that central proposition. At the same time, respondents identified the practical conditions that will determine adoption: credible forecasts, trusted data, confidentiality, governance, integration with planning processes and clear decision value.

> **ENGAGEMENT OUTCOME**
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> The Construction Clients Group engagement provides indicative stakeholder evidence that major construction clients see strong potential value in connecting project-pipeline demand with sector capacity and capability. It establishes a development pathway centred on trusted data, credible forecasting, practical scenario analysis and continued client co-development.

About the engagement and survey

The engagement consisted of a presentation of the CanConstructNZ research programme and Smart System to more than 40 participants associated with major New Zealand construction clients and industry advisers, followed by an invitation to complete an online survey.

The survey explored organisational and procurement perspectives; difficulty understanding future capacity; challenges and consequences associated with aligning project timing and sector capacity; perceived value and preferred functionality of the Smart System; willingness and concerns relating to pipeline-data contribution; potential barriers to adoption; and interest in continued engagement.

Five valid substantive survey responses were analysed after excluding a test response, a blank completed response and incomplete submissions. Percentages therefore refer to valid respondents and should be interpreted as indicative feedback rather than statistically representative estimates of the views of all engagement participants.

The engagement provides stakeholder-relevance and user-needs evidence. It complements, but does not replace, technical model verification, statistical forecasting validation, sensitivity analysis, out-of-sample assessment and subsequent structured user testing.

Source basis

- CanConstructNZ Construction Clients Group engagement presentation, 22 July 2026.
- CanConstructNZ post-engagement online survey, August 2026.
- CanConstructNZ International Workshop, Validation and Academic-Industry Engagement Report, Singapore, June 2026 (benchmark for validation framing).
- Construction Pipeline and Sector Policy Analysis: A Qualitative Approach, June 2026 (benchmark for report structure and visual presentation).